Pet Detection – Annotation Guidelines v1.1

1. Task

Draw a bounding box around every cat and dog in each image and assign the correct class.

2. Classes

- cat (0): any domestic cat, any breed
- dog (1): any domestic dog, any breed

3. Bounding Box Rules

1. Draw a tight box around the full visible body, including the ears, tail and legs. Leave as little background as possible.
2. Fur: include the dense fur outline. Single stray hairs extending beyond it are excluded.
3. Whiskers: exclude them. Do not extend the box to cover whiskers.
4. Occluded (partly hidden): box only the visible part of the animal.
5. Truncated (cut off by the image edge): box up to the image edge.
6. Close-ups: if the animal fills the whole frame, a box covering the full image is correct.
7. Accessories (leash, collar, clothing): do not extend the box to cover them.

4. Multiple Animals

- Give each animal its own separate box.
- Boxes may overlap when animals are close together or one is in front of another.

5. Do Not Label

- Animals smaller than about 20×20 px
- Toys, drawings, statues or reflections of animals
- Images too blurry to identify the animal (note these in the QA log)

6. Quality Checklist (before submitting)

- Is the label correct (cat or dog)?
- Are the ears, tail and legs inside the box?
- Is the box tight, with no extra background?
- Does every animal in the image have its own box?
- Is there no duplicate box on the same animal?

7. Change Log

- v1.0: initial guidelines (classes, box rules, edge cases)
- v1.1: added rules for overlapping animals, fur, whiskers, close-ups and accessories, based on edge cases found during labeling and QA